VULCANISM AND EARTHQUAKES / INDIA SEISMIC ZONES

ENDOGENIC SYSTEM: PLATE MOTION → EARTHQUAKE SOURCE GEOMETRY, DEPTH → SEISMIC WAVES, SHADOW ZONES → GLOBAL SEISMIC BELTS, CASCADING → VOLCANO ANATOMY, MAGMA CONTROLS → VOLCANIC SETTINGS, GLOBAL BELTS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g8 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

ENDOGENIC SYSTEM: PLATE MOTION, STRAIN RELEASE AND MAGMA GENERATION

ENDOGENIC SYSTEM · PLATE MOTION, STRAIN RELEASE AND MAGMA GENERATION · INTERNAL HEAT → GRAVITY + PLATE MOTION RESHAPE CRUST · STRESS ACCUMULATION MAGMA GENERATION LOAD · STRAIN DIVERGENCE · DECOMPRESSION SUBDUCTION · VOLATILE FLUX RUPTURE · SLIP PLUME

ENDOGENIC SYSTEM → internal heat + gravity + plate motion reshape crust. → STRESS ACCUMULATION MAGMA GENERATION load → lock → strain divergence → decompression subduction: volatile flux rupture → slip plume: anomalous upwelling → EARTHQUAKE VULCANISM landforms + hazards + resources

CORE CLAIM

- ENDOGENIC SYSTEM
- Internal heat → gravity + plate motion reshape crust.
- STRESS ACCUMULATION MAGMA GENERATION load → lock → strain divergence
- decompression subduction: volatile flux rupture → slip plume: anomalous upwelling

MECHANISM

- EARTHQUAKE VULCANISM landforms → hazards + resources
- FAULT PAIRS tension → normal
- compression → reverse/thrust
- shear → strike-slip

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Plate motion loads a region; sudden fault rupture is the immediate quake source.
- MUST REMEMBER: Vulcanism and seismicity follow magma generation, ascent, eruption style, fault rupture, wave propagation and site response
- India requires Himalayan collision, Kachchh intraplate strain, Peninsular reservoirs/faults, Andaman subduction and Barren Island anchors.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Plate tectonics gives the spatial grammar of seismicity and vulcanism, but the examiner still expects the immediate mechanics—fault slip for an earthquake and magma ascent for an eruption.

01

STAGE 01

EARTHQUAKE SOURCE GEOMETRY, DEPTH AND SEISMOGRAM LOGIC

EARTHQUAKE SOURCE GEOMETRY, DEPTH AND SEISMOGRAM LOGIC · SURFACE STATION A ·------· EPICENTRE ·------· STATION B FOCUS · HYPOCENTRE RUPTURE BEGINS ON FAULT PLANE · SEISMOGRAM ARRIVAL ORDER · P FIRST · S SECOND · LOVE AND RAYLEIGH LATER · P-S INTERVAL AT ONE STATION GIVES SOURCE DISTANCE THREE

SURFACE station A ·------· epicentre ·------· station B focus / hypocentre rupture begins on fault

SEISMOGRAM ARRIVAL ORDER → P first → S second → Love and Rayleigh later → P-S interval at one station gives source distance three or more distance circles estimate the

CORE CLAIM

- SURFACE station A ·------· epicentre ·------· station B focus / hypocentre rupture begins on fault plane
- SEISMOGRAM ARRIVAL ORDER
- P first → S second → Love and Rayleigh later
- P-S interval at one station gives source distance three or more distance circles estimate the epicentre

MECHANISM

- DEPTH CLASS: shallow: 0–70 km
- intermediate: 70–300 km
- deep: 300–700 km
- SEQUENCE FIREWALL foreshock, mainshock and aftershock are relational labels

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- a swarm has no single clearly dominant event
- Epicentre is a vertical projection, not necessarily the worst-damaged place.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SEQUENCE FIREWALL foreshock, mainshock and aftershock are relational labels.

02

STAGE 02

SEISMIC WAVES, SHADOW ZONES, MAGNITUDE AND INTENSITY

SEISMIC WAVES, SHADOW ZONES, MAGNITUDE AND INTENSITY · MAIN CLUE · SOLID, LIQUID · CORE REFRACTION · TRANSVERSE SHEAR · SOLID ONLY · LIQUID OUTER CORE · HORIZONTAL SHEAR

WAVE	MOTION	MEDIUM	MAIN CLUE
P	compression	solid, liquid	core refraction
S	transverse shear	solid only	liquid outer core
Love	horizontal shear	surface	lateral shaking
Rayleigh	rolling ellipse	surface	mixed motion
P shadow about 103–142 deg	direct S shadow beyond about 103 deg		

CORE CLAIM

- MAIN CLUE
- solid, liquid
- core refraction
- transverse shear
- solid only

MECHANISM

- liquid outer core
- horizontal shear
- lateral shaking
- rolling ellipse
- mixed motion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- P shadow about 103–142 deg
- direct S shadow beyond about 103 deg
- MAGNITUDE: one source measure. Me uses seismic moment moment = rigidity x fault area x average slip
- 1 local magnitude gives about 10x amplitude and 31.6x energy
- INTENSITY: place-specific observed effects; many values for one event source x path x site x exposure x vulnerability / capacity → damage

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Focal depth is a source descriptor, whereas disaster severity is a relational outcome produced by source, path, site, exposure and vulnerability.

03

STAGE 03

GLOBAL SEISMIC BELTS, CASCADING HAZARDS AND TSUNAMI SEQUENCE

GLOBAL SEISMIC BELTS, CASCADING HAZARDS AND TSUNAMI SEQUENCE · GLOBAL EARTHQUAKE DISTRIBUTION · RIDGES/TRANSFORMS TRENCH + SLAB + ARC · HIMALAYAN COLLISION · SHALLOW EVENTS MEGATHRUST + TSUNAMI · COMPLEX CONVERGENCE · BASALTIC RIDGES · INTRAPLATE EVENTS REACTIVATE INHERITED STRUCTURES; STABLE IS NOT ASEISMIC

GLOBAL EARTHQUAKE DISTRIBUTION → Ridges/transforms trench + slab + arc → Himalayan collision → shallow events megathrust + tsunami → complex convergence

CORE CLAIM

- GLOBAL EARTHQUAKE DISTRIBUTION
- Ridges/transforms trench + slab + arc
- Himalayan collision
- shallow events megathrust + tsunami
- complex convergence

MECHANISM

- basaltic ridges
- Intraplate events reactivate inherited structures; stable is not aseismic.
- CASCADE shaking → amplification / liquefaction / lateral spreading
- landslide / fire / lifeline failure / dam distress
- TSUNAMI submarine megathrust → vertical sea-floor displacement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- long low deep ocean wave → coastal shoaling
- run-up > inundation + return flow
- First wave need not be largest; withdrawal need not occur before every event.
- Risk varies with bathymetry, bay shape, shelf, exposure and evacuation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Depth distribution is the diagnostic map layer: only a descending slab generates a systematic inclined belt from shallow trench earthquakes to intermediate and deep events.

04

STAGE 04

VOLCANO ANATOMY, MAGMA CONTROLS, LANDFORMS AND ERUPTION STYLES

VOLCANO ANATOMY, MAGMA CONTROLS, LANDFORMS AND ERUPTION STYLES · ASH PLUME · \ CRATER LAVA ·-·-· LAVA VENT DYKE · SILL CONDUIT MAGMA CHAMBER · MAGMA BELOW SURFACE · LAVA AFTER ERUPTION · SILICA UP · VISCOSITY UP

ash plume

\ crater lava ·-·-· lava vent dyke → sill conduit magma chamber → Magma below surface

CORE CLAIM

- ash plume
- \ crater lava ·-·-· lava vent dyke
- sill conduit magma chamber
- Magma below surface
- lava after eruption

MECHANISM

- Temperature up → viscosity generally down
- Retained gas + decompression → bubbles → fragmentation
- FORMS: batholith, laccolith, lopolith, phacolith, dyke, sill
- Dyke cuts layers; sill follows layers
- STYLE: fissure/Icelandic → Hawaiian → Strombolian → Vulcanian → Plinian

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- cinder cone
- fissure plateau
- STATUS: active
- extinct: status is not a compulsory life cycle.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Active status concerns eruptive capability; shield/composite concerns form; Hawaiian/Plinian concerns behaviour—UPSC can mix these axes in close options.

05

STAGE 05

VOLCANIC SETTINGS, GLOBAL BELTS, PRODUCTS AND ENVIRONMENTAL EFFECTS

VOLCANIC SETTINGS, GLOBAL BELTS, PRODUCTS AND ENVIRONMENTAL EFFECTS · MELTING MECHANISM · RIDGE, RIFT, BASALT · SLAB VOLATILE FLUX · TRENCH-SLAB-ARC SYSTEM · MANTLE UPWELLING · FLOOD BASALT, HOT SPOT · RING OF FIRE

SETTING	MELTING MECHANISM	EXPRESSION	
Divergent	decompression	ridge, rift, basalt	
Subduction	slab volatile flux	trench-slab-arc system	
Plume	mantle upwelling	flood basalt, hot spot	
BENEFITS: new crust/land	soil parent	geothermal energy	minerals

CORE CLAIM

- MELTING MECHANISM
- ridge, rift, basalt
- slab volatile flux
- trench-slab-arc system
- mantle upwelling

MECHANISM

- Ring of Fire = trench + descending slab + earthquakes + volcanic arc
- Plume model: broad head may form flood basalt; tail may form age chain.
- Deccan Trap is a fissure-fed flood-basalt plateau, not a giant cone.
- HAZARDS: lava
- density currents

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BENEFITS: new crust/land
- soil parent
- geothermal energy
- Impact converges through wind, relief, drainage, exposure and preparedness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Deccan Trap is a fissure-fed flood-basalt plateau, not a giant cone.

06

STAGE 06

INDIA SEISMIC GEOGRAPHY, ZONATION, INSTITUTIONS AND RESILIENCE STACK

INDIA SEISMIC GEOGRAPHY, ZONATION, INSTITUTIONS AND RESILIENCE STACK · INDIA REGIONAL HIERARCHY · COLLISION, THRUSTS, SLOPES, DENSE CORRIDORS · CONVERGENCE, STRIKE-SLIP COMPLEXITY · SUBDUCTION, TSUNAMI, BARREN ISLAND VOLCANISM · INHERITED RIFT AND FAULT REACTIVATION · RELATIVELY STABLE, KOYNA AND LATUR SHOW RESIDUAL RISK · ALLUVIUM, AMPLIFICATION AND HIGH EXPOSURE

INDIA REGIONAL HIERARCHY

Himalaya : collision, thrusts, slopes, dense corridors → North-East : convergence, strike-slip complexity → Andaman : subduction, tsunami, Barren Island volcanism

CORE CLAIM

- INDIA REGIONAL HIERARCHY
- Himalaya : collision, thrusts, slopes, dense corridors
- North-East : convergence, strike-slip complexity
- Andaman : subduction, tsunami, Barren Island volcanism
- Kachchh : inherited rift and fault reactivation

MECHANISM

- Indo-Gangetic : alluvium, amplification and high exposure
- MACROZONATION: broad design hazard, not prediction
- MICROZONATION: geology + soil + motion + water + liquefaction + GIS
- NCS/MoES → monitoring
- GSI → geology

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NCMA/NDM → guidance
- INCOIS → tsunami warning
- States/ULBs → approvals + inspection + enforcement site → regular load path → ductility → connections
- non-structural safety → quality control → retrofit → drills
- Early warning detects rupture after it starts; it is not prediction.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Macrozonation tells a city the regional design problem; microzonation tells neighbourhoods how local ground modifies that problem.

07

STAGE 07

HAZARD-RISK-RESPONSE AND MAINS ANSWER SPINE FOR SEISMIC INDIA

HAZARD-RISK-RESPONSE AND MAINS ANSWER SPINE FOR SEISMIC INDIA · WHY CAN SIMILAR EARTHQUAKES PRODUCE UNEQUAL DISASTERS? · SOURCE SIZE → DEPTH → RUPTURE GEOMETRY → PATH · BASIN SEDIMENT + GROUNDWATER + SLOPE + LIQUEFACTION POTENTIAL · PEOPLE + BUILDINGS + LIFELINES + TIME OF OCCURRENCE · WEAK DESIGN + IRREGULAR FORM + POOR MAINTENANCE · CODES + ENFORCEMENT + RETROFIT + WARNING + RESPONSE · RISK VERDICT

CORE CLAIM

- QUESTION: Why can similar earthquakes produce unequal disasters?
- HAZARD: source size + depth + rupture geometry + path
- SITE: basin sediment + groundwater + slope + liquefaction potential
- EXPOSURE: people + buildings + lifelines + time of occurrence
- VULNERABILITY: weak design + irregular form + poor maintenance

MECHANISM

- CAPACITY: codes + enforcement + retrofit + warning + response
- RISK VERDICT: hazard becomes disaster through social and spatial filters
- 15-MARK INDIA SPINE: tectonic regions → site modifiers → exposure/vulnerability → cases
- zonation and microzonation → construction and governance → conclusion
- TRAPS: focus is not epicentre

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- magnitude is not intensity; tsunami is not a tide
- caldera is not an ordinary crater zone map is not prediction
- code publication is not enforcement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: zonation and microzonation → construction and governance → conclusion.

08

STAGE 08

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL · EVIDENCE LADDER · FROM SOURCE BOOK · STANDARD KNOWLEDGE · CURRENT AFFAIRS · 2. EXTINCT VOLCANO GEOLOGICAL EVIDENCE INDICATES ERUPTION IS NO · 3. GEOPHYSICAL EVIDENCE; A LONG-QUIESCENT VOLCANO MAY STILL BE · SOURCE TYPE CONTROLS THE STRENGTH AND LIMITS OF THE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Extinct volcano Geological evidence indicates eruption is no longer...	VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
1. » from source book » inference / standard knowledge » current affairs.	3. geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.	EVIDENCE LADDER

CORE CLAIM

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. » from source book » inference / standard knowledge » current affairs.

MECHANISM

- 2. Extinct volcano Geological evidence indicates eruption is no longer...
- 3. geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

09

STAGE 09

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES · CLOSE DISTINCTIONS · 1. CAUSAL METHOD INITIAL CONDITION · ENERGY/FORCE OR DRIVER → · 2. PIB/MOES - UPDATED SEISMIC ZONATION MAP STATEMENT, 17 · 3. SCALE, INTERACTING CONTROL OR EVIDENCE LIMIT · QUALIFICATION EARNS MARKS; FALSE CERTAINTY IS A HARD FAILURE. · CLOSE DISTINCTION:

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CLOSE DISTINCTIONS	3. SCALE, INTERACTING CONTROL OR EVIDENCE LIMIT	focus differs from epicentre. P differs from S and surface waves, and a tsunami requires water-column displacement rather
1. Causal method Initial condition → energy/force or driver →...	VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.	
2. PIB/MoES - updated seismic zonation map statement, 17 December 2025,...	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Magnitude measures source size whereas intensity records effects	

CORE CLAIM

- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
- 1. Causal method Initial condition → energy/force or driver →...
- 2. PIB/MoES - updated seismic zonation map statement, 17 December 2025,...

MECHANISM

- 3. SCALE, INTERACTING CONTROL OR EVIDENCE LIMIT
- VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Magnitude measures source size whereas intensity records effects

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- focus differs from epicentre. P differs from S and surface waves, and a tsunami requires water-column displacement rather

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

10

STAGE 10

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION · ANSWER SPINE · 1. CROSS-OWNED BUT DIRECTLY RELEVANT MAINS PYQ 1 · 2. ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS PRACTICE 6 · 3. PRACTICE CONTRACT EVERY SOLVED ITEM HAS DEMAND DECODING · CLAIM, NAMED EVIDENCE, ANALYSIS AND QUALIFICATION LEAD TO A · EVIDENCE LIMIT · HAZARD IS NOT DISASTER

ANSWER SPINE

1. Cross-owned but directly relevant Mains PYQ 1 → 2. Original solved Mains practice 6 → 3. Practice contract Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed

CORE CLAIM

- ANSWER SPINE
- 1. Cross-owned but directly relevant Mains PYQ 1
- 2. Original solved Mains practice 6

MECHANISM

- 3. Practice contract Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed...
- VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Hazard is not disaster; exposure, vulnerability, construction and preparedness mediate loss

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- seismic zonation is probabilistic and revised through evidence, while prediction claims must not be confused with monitoring or early warning.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded.

11

STAGE 11

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL — DEEP-REVIEW SYNTHESIS 2

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL — DEEP-REVIEW SYNTHESIS 2 · EVIDENCE LADDER · FROM SOURCE BOOK · STANDARD KNOWLEDGE · CURRENT AFFAIRS · 2. EXTINCT VOLCANO GEOLOGICAL EVIDENCE INDICATES ERUPTION IS NO · 3. GEOPHYSICAL EVIDENCE; A LONG-QUIESCENT VOLCANO MAY STILL BE · SOURCE TYPE CONTROLS THE STRENGTH AND LIMITS OF THE

EVIDENCE LADDER → 1. » from source book » inference / standard knowledge » current affairs. → 2. Extinct volcano Geological evidence indicates eruption is no longer → 3. geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant. → VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

CORE CLAIM

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. » from source book » inference / standard knowledge » current affairs.

MECHANISM

- 2. Extinct volcano Geological evidence indicates eruption is no longer...
- 3. geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Arrival order is P first, S second and surface waves later; medium control is P through solids and liquids but S through solids only.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED 1 — FINITE-FAULT RUPTURE, DIRECTIVITY AND FREQUENCY-DEPENDENT SITE · ADVANCED 2 — SEISMIC CYCLE, PALAEOSEISMOLOGY AND PROBABILITY · ADVANCED 3 — CODE HIERARCHY, PERFORMANCE AND RETROFIT TRIAGE · ADVANCED 4 — EARTHQUAKE EARLY WARNING AND OPERATIONAL LIMITS · ADVANCED 5 — VOLCANIC MONITORING AND ERUPTION-STYLE UNCERTAINTY · DIRECTIVITY HELPS EXPLAIN ELONGATED DAMAGE PATTERNS THAT A SIMPLE · FREQUENCY CONTENT MATTERS!

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- ADVANCED 1 — FINITE-FAULT RUPTURE, DIRECTIVITY AND FREQUENCY-DEPENDENT SITE RESPONSE
- ADVANCED 2 — SEISMIC CYCLE, PALAEOSEISMOLOGY AND PROBABILITY
- ADVANCED 3 — CODE HIERARCHY, PERFORMANCE AND RETROFIT TRIAGE
- ADVANCED 4 — EARTHQUAKE EARLY WARNING AND OPERATIONAL LIMITS

ADVANCED DEBATE

- ADVANCED 5 — VOLCANIC MONITORING AND ERUPTION-STYLE UNCERTAINTY
- Directivity helps explain elongated damage patterns that a simple epicentral circle cannot.
- Frequency content matters: short stiff structures respond differently from tall flexible structures.
- Resonance occurs when dominant ground periods approach a structure's natural period.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Basin-edge effects can focus or convert waves; deep basins may prolong long-period shaking.
- Nonlinearity: very strong shaking can change soil stiffness and damping, so weak-motion amplification cannot always be extrapolated directly.
- earthquake swarms and volcanic tremor
- deformation from GPS, tilt and satellite radar.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.